Islamic Studies / Ethics

Course Summary — Topics, Concepts, Qur'anic Verses & Hadiths (Document pages 12–64)

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1. Why Do We Need Religion? (pp. 12–16)

An introspective opening essay challenging the reader to examine faith consciously rather than as inherited habit — do we truly understand what we recite and believe, or are we repeating what we were taught?

The essay then poses the question **"Who is behind existence, order and purpose?"** through seven wonders of nature, each ending in a rhetorical question about a Designer:

- **01 – A Universe Beyond Imagination:** the scale of the observable universe (2+ trillion galaxies).
- **02 – A Beginning:** why is there something rather than nothing (the Big Bang).
- **03 – The Atom:** the ordered, invisible architecture of matter.
- **04 – A Seed That Knows How to Become a Tree:** germination and biological information.
- **05 – From a Tiny Beginning to a Thinking Human:** embryology and neural development.
- **06 – The Heart You Never Have to Command:** the autonomic heartbeat.
- **07 – The Epiglottis:** the silent, precise reflex protecting the airway.

The Question the Qur'an Asks — after presenting these wonders, the notes cite:

> *"Were they created by nothing, or are they themselves the creators?"*
>
> Qur'an 52:35 (Surah at-Tur)

2. Introduction to Religion (pp. 17–21)

Etymology

- **Religion** — from Old French *"Religiun"* ("respect for what is sacred") and Latin *"Religionem"* ("reverence for the gods").
- **Mazhab** — Urdu/Arabic word meaning "a way to go", "a path", "a method" — in Arabic used for "point of view"/"school of thought", not exactly "religion".
- **Deen** — the Arabic word actually used in the Qur'an and Hadith for "religion"; also means retaliation, recompense, requital, commandment, judgment.

> *(Allah is) "The Master of the Day of Judgment."*
>
> Referenced as an example of the word 'Deen' in the Qur'an (Surah al-Fatihah 1:4)

Other Qur'anic words used in the sense of religion: *Millah*, *Siraat*, *Minhaaj*, *Shir'ah* — but "Deen" is preferred because it indicates requital/recompense of deeds in the afterlife.

Definitions of Religion — Western Scholars

- **Edward Burnett Tylor (1832–1917)**, *Primitive Culture*: "The belief in spiritual being."

- **David Émile Durkheim (1858–1917)**, *The Elementary Forms of the Religious Life*: "Unified system of beliefs and practices relative to sacred things."
- **William James (1842–1910)**, *The Varieties of Religious Experience*: "The feelings, acts and experiences of individual men in their solitude, whatever they may consider the divine."

Analysis: Western thought tends to treat religion as a private, individual, belief-centred matter. The Divine/Eastern (Islamic) perspective instead treats religion as a complete, practical, and collective code of life — roughly 90% practice-oriented rather than purely doctrinal.

Divine Perspective

> *"Religion is a complete code of life set and sent down by the Creator, the Lord (God), through His messengers from time to time to guide His slaves (Mankind & Jinn) to success in life and the afterlife."*

Need for Religion

Religion is described as an essential need of mankind because it gives meaning to the essence of life, creates an objective for existence, and establishes the core of mankind.

Demand of Nature (Fitrah)

Although liberty and freedom have always fascinated human beings — who by nature prefer liberation from confinement — the reality is that 80–85% of the world's population is affiliated with some religion, willingly accepting the restrictions and confinements that religion sets. The notes argue this apparent contradiction is resolved by recognising that association with religion is itself a demand of innate human nature (*fitrah*) that man was created with.

Nature is defined as an essential feature by which a particular object is recognised and known; if that feature is removed, the object is no longer the same. For example, water is known by its liquidity and flow — remove that, and it becomes ice, not water any more. In the same way, man has been created with a built-in disposition to believe in an unseen supernatural power (God), whether or not he consciously recognises it.

This is demonstrated through lived experience: when a person determines to achieve a goal and struggles hard yet eventually fails despite every effort, or when a person suffers from undesired diseases, mishaps, and disasters, these experiences compel man to believe in some other, more powerful and influential being existing beyond himself. Man is naturally frightened that this power may cause him harm if angered, and so he yields to it in order to secure himself from failure and to gain benefit and advantage. It is in this way that religion takes birth — and it is only belief in God that gives security to the self and mind, peace to the soul, meaning to the individual, and satisfaction to human nature.

- **The God Gene hypothesis** — Dean H. Hamer, *The God Gene: How Faith Is Hardwired into Our Genes* (2004): proposes the VMAT2 gene may predispose humans toward spiritual/mystical experience, linking biological factors (serotonin, dopamine and other neurotransmitters) to religious or mystical experience.
- **Andrew Newberg**, *How God Changes Your Brain* (2009): neuroscientific research (in the field of neuroethology) showing specific brain regions activated during mystical/religious states, and that practices like prayer and meditation alter brain function, enhancing feelings of peace and connection — supporting a neurobiological basis for spirituality.

Craving of the Mind for the Knowledge of Essential Facts

The human need for a creed primarily derives from man's innate craving to know himself and the universe around him. Since creation, people have had the nagging questions “From where?”, “To where?” and “Why?” — questions that are sometimes overshadowed by the demands of daily life but that people eventually return to.

Man wonders from where he and this immeasurable universe came: did he come into existence on his own, or is there a Creator who brought him into existence — and how is he related to Him? He wonders about the vast land, sky, animals, vegetation, minerals, planets and stars, and about why life is possible on Earth, even though such things are treated as unremarkable simply because they happen daily.

Further questions posed: did the universe and living things come into existence on their own, or is there a sovereign Creator? What comes after this life — is there nothing beyond death, or is there another life in which the virtuous are rewarded and the wicked punished? Why was mankind brought into existence, and why was mankind endowed with mind, wisdom, knowledge and volition that distinguish humans from animals? The notes state that answers satisfying both intellect and heart are found only in religion — in a pure religious belief that man was created by a great Creator (God), Who fashioned him perfectly, gave him due proportion, breathed soul into him, endowed him with hearing, eyesight, mind and heart, and granted him all sorts of blessings starting as an embryo in his mother's womb.

Classification of Religions

Of roughly 9,000 world religions (including tribal religions), they are classified as:

- **Revealed religions** — claim a divine scripture: Judaism, Christianity, Islam.
- **Non-revealed religions** — no claimed divine scripture, though some have sacred/holy books.

Six Theological Worldviews

- **Atheism** — denies the existence of God/any divine being; universe held to be self-existent.
- **Agnosticism** — uncertainty about God's existence (term coined by Thomas Huxley, 19th c.).
- **Deism** — a Creator exists but does not intervene or reveal further guidance (e.g., Voltaire, Jefferson).
- **Pantheism** — God and the universe are identical (e.g., Spinoza, strands of Hinduism).
- **Monotheism** — one all-powerful, transcendent God who is Creator and Sustainer (Judaism, Christianity, Islam).
- **Polytheism** — belief in multiple deities (e.g., ancient Greece, Rome, Egypt).

3. Introduction to Islam (pp. 22–28)

Etymology & Definition

“Islam” derives from the Arabic root *Salama*, meaning “Peace” and “Safeness”; it literally also means “Obedience”, “Submission”, and “Surrender”.

> *A complete code of life revealed by Allah (the Creator, the Owner, the Sustainer & the Lord) to His Prophets & Messengers, from Adam AS to Muhammad (PBUH), to guide His slaves*

> *(Mankind & Jinn) to success in life and the afterlife.*

Important Note — Islam vs Other Religions

Unlike other religions (often limited to birth, marriage and death rituals), Islam is a complete, systematic code covering worship, family, social dealings, economics, politics and law, as well as everyday routines like eating, drinking, sleeping and dressing.

> *And truly, this is the revelation from the Lord of all worlds. The trustworthy spirit (Jibraeel) brought it down, upon your heart, so that you may become one of the warners, in plain Arabic language.*
>
> Qur'an 26:192–195

The Subject & Objective of Islam

“Subject” refers to the study of a particular thing discussed under a discipline — for example, the human body is the subject of medical science, and a machine is the subject of engineering. In the same way, when Islam is considered as a discipline and a complete code for life, there must be a subject discussed within it. The subject of the entire Islamic teachings is human beings and Jinn, as slaves to Allah:

> *I did not create mankind and Jinn except for the purpose that they should worship Me.*
>
> Qur'an 51:56 (Adh-Dhariyat)

Islam reveals the teachings through which human beings may enable themselves to become good slaves of Allah the Almighty.

Objective: to provide complete guidance leading mankind and Jinn to success in life and the afterlife. A noteworthy point is that the actual concept of success, as interpreted by the Qur'an, lies down with safe removal from the fire of Hell and entrance into Paradise:

> *So, whoever is safely removed from the Fire of Hell and admitted to Paradise, he succeeded indeed. And the worldly life is not but the goods of delusion.*
>
> Qur'an 3:185

The verse reveals that beyond this actual success, no worldly success is appreciable or reliable, especially since this world itself is mortal, until man is safely removed from the fire of Hell.

The Fore Face of Islam

In a very famous Hadith of Prophet Muhammad (PBUH), entitled Hadith-e-Jibraeel, the Prophet introduced Islam by its “face features” as a reply to a question asked by Jibreel. Hazrat Umar (RA) reports that once Jibraeel (AS) came to see the Prophet (PBUH) in the attire of a man while some of the companions (including the reporter) were sitting around him in the Holy Mosque of Madinah. He asked a few questions which were replied to by the Prophet (PBUH).

Hadith-e-Jibraeel — Full Text (Sahih Muslim: 93)

1) Islam — Five Pillars

- **Shahada** — declaring the oneness of God and the Prophethood of Muhammad (PBUH).
- **Salah** — performing the five daily prayers.
- **Zakat** — giving alms to the poor and needy.

- **Sawm** — fasting during the month of Ramadan.
- **Hajj** — pilgrimage to Mecca for those who are able.

2) Iman — Six Articles of Faith

- Belief in Allah
- His angels
- His books
- His messengers
- The Day of Judgment
- Predestination (Qadar) — that good and bad are decreed by Allah

3) Ihsan (Excellence in Worship)

> *To worship Allah as if you see Him, and even though you do not see Him, you should know that He sees you.*
>
> Sahih Muslim: 93

The Structure of Islam (outline)

- **I. Foundations:** Tawheed (Oneness of God) · Risalah (Prophethood) · Akhirah (Hereafter)
- **II. Religious Structure** — A) Beliefs (Iman, 6 articles); B) Practices (Ibadah, 5 pillars); C) Sources of Law: Qur'an, Sunnah, Ijma (Consensus), Qiyas (Analogy)
- **III. Islamic Systems** — A) Social System (human dignity, family, marriage/divorce, gender roles, rights of neighbours/orphans); B) Ethical System (Halal vs Haram, integrity, justice/'Adl, accountability before God); C) Political System (Shura/consultation, Caliphate, governance under Sharia, justice & law enforcement); D) Economic System (Zakat, prohibition of Riba, Islamic banking, fair trade & charity)

Why Islam? — Convert Case Studies

The notes reference modern conversion stories (e.g., Lauren Booth, Kristiane Backer, Alfie Best Jr., and the book/series “Why I Chose Islam”), plus the “Towards Eternity” YouTube channel, as case studies for reflecting on why people embrace Islam.

Finality of Islam

> *Truly, the religion with Allah is Islam.*
>
> Qur'an 3:19

> *O you who believe, be afraid of Allah as He deserves to be feared, and let not yourself die save as Muslims.*
>
> Qur'an 3:102

> *And whoever seeks a religion other than Islam, it will never be accepted from him, and he, in the hereafter, will be among the losers.*
>
> Qur'an 3:85

> *Those who disbelieve and die as disbelievers, an earth-full of gold even shall never be accepted from any of them... They are the ones for whom there is a painful punishment, and*

for them there are no helpers.

Qur'an 3:91

I swear by the One who holds the life of Muhammad, any of the Jew or Christian from among the people who comes to know about me, and then dies without having faith in what I have been sent with (Islam), he will definitely be among the Hell members.

Hadith — Abu Huraira (RA); Sahih Muslim: 386

4. The Belief System of Islam — Iman (pp. 29–39)

Definition of Iman

Linguistically from the root *a-m-n*, meaning security, affirmation, trust. Technically: firm conviction and acceptance of what was revealed to Prophet Muhammad ●.

> *Iman is to believe with the heart, confess with the tongue, and act with the limbs.*

> *Indeed, those who have believed and done righteous deeds — they will have the Gardens of Paradise as a lodging.*
>
> Qur'an 18:107

The Six Articles of Faith (Arkan al-Iman) are derived from the Qur'an and the Hadith of Jibraeel:

- 1) Iman bi-Tawhid — Belief in the Oneness of Allah
- 2) Iman bil-Mala'ikah — Belief in the Angels
- 3) Iman bil-Kutub — Belief in the Books
- 4) Iman bir-Rusul — Belief in the Prophets
- 5) Iman bil-Yawm al-Akhira — Belief in the Last Day
- 6) Iman bil-Qadar — Belief in Divine Decree

5. Tawhid — Oneness of God (pp. 30–34)

Tawhid means attributing Oneness to Allah and describing Him as One and Unique, with no partner or peer in His Essence and Attributes. It is the most sensitive and significant creed in the sight of Allah, and the foundation of Islam is based on this creed — without deep cognition of it, our faith is at stake, and we can never achieve the essence of Iman without comprehending this belief. Without recognising Him, we can never develop a relationship with Him.

Recommended readings suggested in the notes: *The Fundamentals of Tawheed* by Dr. Bilal Philips; *Islamic Belief System* by Jamal al-Din Zarabozo; and selected chapters from Sahih Muslim and Sahih al-Bukhari on Iman.

> *Those who truly fear Allah, among His servants, who know Allah.*

Tawhid is the primary and core subject of the Qur'an. **Surah al-Ikhlas** is described in Hadith as equal to one-third of the Qur'an because it encapsulates the essence of Tawhid:

> *Proclaim: He is Allah, Who is the One. Allah is the Transcendent of all, the Protector and Far-Superior to all. He has not begotten any, nor is He begotten. Nor is there anyone equal to Him.*
>
> Qur'an 112:1–4 (Surah al-Ikhlas); Hadith reference — Sahih al-Bukhari: 5013

Allah the Almighty is the most Unique and Exalted, as He is the Creator. Nothing can be compared to Him. He is the most Supreme Being in the entire world. He alone is the Sustainer of all the universes and the whole creation; everything is dependent on Him but He is independent of everyone. His being is the practical manifestation of absolute Oneness. Tawhid is the main theme, crux and focal teaching of the Qur'an:

> *And We did not send any Messenger before you, but We revealed to him (saying): none has the right to be worshipped but I (Allah), so worship Me (Alone).*
>
> Qur'an 21:25

> *And verily, We have sent among every Ummah (nation) a Messenger (proclaiming): Worship Allah (Alone), and avoid (or keep away from) Taghut.*
>
> Qur'an 16:36

The repeated statement of Tawhid, in diverse ways and at different places in the Qur'an, indicates its emphasis and significance — Allah used the same statement about Tawhid for every Prophet. So, until the Last Messenger, the message of the Oneness of Allah was sent to mankind with the same importance.

Three Types of Tawhid

- **Rububiyah (Lordship):** based on the fundamental concept that Allah alone caused all things to exist when there was nothing — known as creation *ex nihilo* ("out of nothing"), the doctrine that matter is not eternal but had to be created by a divine act. He sustains and maintains creation without any need from it or for it, and is the sole Lord of the universe without any real challenge to His sovereignty. The Arabic term derives from the root "Rabb" (Lord), proved by Allah's statement in Surah al-Fatihah, verse 1: "[All] praise is due to Allah, Lord of the world's mankind, jinn, and all that exists." Since God is the only real power in existence, it is He who gave all things the power to move and change — everything is dependent on Him, and He alone is independent. These facts are explained comprehensively in Surah an-Naml, verses 60–65.
- **Uluhiyyah (Worship):** having firm conviction that only Allah is the true and only God worthy of worship. The Arabic term *ibadah* (worship) is associated with obedience, subservience and submission, and has been defined by scholars as "complete love accompanied by complete submission." Worship in all its forms cannot be dedicated to anyone besides Allah — this concept is all-embracing, transcending the five pillars of Islam to cover all good deeds that please Allah, including supplication, reliance, obedience and subservience. The Kalima ("La ilaha illallah" — there is no ilah [one worthy of worship] other than the one being known as Allah) is given as the clearest example of Uluhiyyah: in the whole universe there is absolutely no being worthy to be worshipped other than Allah, and it is only to Him that our heads should bow in submission and adoration. Prayers, charity, dua, tawaf, sajda etc. are acts of worship — performing them for anyone else besides Allah constitutes shirk.
- **Asmaa was-Sifaat (Names & Attributes):** this category has five main aspects — (1) the unity of Allah's names and attributes must be maintained; (2) Allah must be referred to according to how He and Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) have described Him, rather than reinterpreting His names/attributes to mean something other than their obvious meanings; (3) Allah must be referred to without giving Him any new names or attributes beyond what He has used for Himself — for example, the Bible and Torah claim Allah spent six days creating the universe then rested on the seventh (which is why Jews and Christians observe Saturday/Sunday as a day of rest), a claim Islam rejects as attributing a creaturely limitation to Allah; (4) no human being should be given Allah's attributes at His level — all attributes in reality belong to Allah, and while He has distributed some of these attributes to creation for a certain period (e.g., a man can be *Raheem*/merciful, but not at Allah's level), the attributes of Allah are incomparable, independent, and free from beginning or end, unlike the limited and confined abilities of creation.

The Example of Hayy and Qayyum

Al-Hayy (the Ever-Living) and **al-Qayyum** (the Self-Subsisting) are two of Allah's exclusive and incomparable attributes. They affirm that He alone possesses true and absolute life that is not

derived, sustained, or dependent on anything else, and His existence has no beginning and no end, and nothing sustains Him. He is completely unlike creation: He is entirely independent, necessary, and non-contingent — nothing causes Him to exist, and nothing sustains Him. He is also beyond all limitations of time, for time itself is His creation; before time came into existence, He already was, and His existence does not unfold within time nor is it affected by change or progression. Thus, He alone is truly eternal, immortal, and everlasting — unceasing in His being, never subject to decay, interruption, or extinction.

> *And I (Allah) did not create the jinn and men except that they should worship Me (alone).*
>
> Qur'an 51:56 (Surah adh-Dhariyat)

6. Shirk — The Unforgivable Sin (pp. 35–38)

> *And indeed, it has been revealed to you (O Muhammad), as it was to those before you: If you join others in worship with Allah, (then) surely (all) your deeds will be in vain, and you will certainly be among the losers.*
>
> Qur'an 39:65 (Az-Zumar)

> *Verily, Allah forgives not that partners should be set up with Him, but He forgives what is less than that to whomever He wills...*
>
> Qur'an 4:48 (An-Nisa)

The notes explain: on the Day of Judgment, Allah will ask whoever performed a deed for someone/something other than Him to go and seek its reward from that false god instead.

The Bible's Account vs. the Qur'an's Account of Prophet Isa (Jesus)

The notes contrast the two scriptures' treatment of this theme. The Bible describes that on the Day of Judgment, people will come to Prophet Jesus saying “O Lord, O Lord, we did charity in Thy name,” citing their good deeds done in his name — and Jesus will reply that he never knew them, and tell them to get away as evildoers.

The Qur'an, by contrast, describes Allah directly questioning Prophet Isa: “O Isa, did you tell them to worship you besides Me? Or your mother besides Me?” — and Isa replies that Allah knows what is in his heart, and that he never told people to worship him. The notes state that Allah has categorically mentioned in the Qur'an that Isa and his mother do not have the authority to be anyone's intercessor/beneficiary, and that those who worship them will be in severe trouble on the Final Day.

Fitrah and Shirk

Our intrinsic nature (*Fitrah*) is inclined towards the Oneness of God, and the entire design of nature reflects the glory and Oneness of a single Designer. This is precisely what makes shirk an unforgivable sin — because all the proofs of the Oneness of God are already present within us, so committing shirk means going against one's own nature.

Repentance Before Death — Hadith

A Sahih Hadith recounts: an old man came to the Prophet (PBUH) leaning on a stick for support and asked what he thought of a person who had committed every sin, big and small, and left none of them out. “Ya Rasulullah! I am an old man, I have done all of that,” he said. The Prophet (PBUH) asked him, “Have you said the Shahada?” He said yes.

The Prophet (PBUH) then said: from this moment, if you do righteous deeds and don't return to those sins, Allah will forgive you and will turn your bad deeds into good deeds. The man was shocked and asked whether even his treachery and the ways he had hurt other people would be forgiven. The Prophet (PBUH) said, “Yes, even those.” The old man then lifted his stick and went back, proclaiming “Allahu Akbar, Allahu Akbar” — illustrating the true significance of sincere repentance and how it changes a person's way of life.

Types of Shirk

The texts of the Qur'an and Sunnah indicate that shirk and the ascribing of rivals to Allah sometimes puts a person beyond the pale of Islam, and sometimes does not. Scholars therefore divided shirk into two types: *shirk akbar* (major shirk) and *shirk asghar* (minor shirk).

- **Major Shirk (Shirk Akbar):** ascribing Lordship, Divinity or Divine Names/Attributes to other than Allah — e.g., belief in another creator/sustainer, absolute obedience to other than Allah against the religion of the Messengers, loving a created being as Allah is loved, or believing someone besides Allah knows the unseen or bestows mercy as He does.
- **Minor Shirk (Shirk Asghar):** lesser acts that can lead to major shirk. Usually of two types — (1) being emotionally attached to means with no basis in Shariah, such as hanging beads, amulets, or turquoise, believing they offer protection or ward off the evil eye, when Allah has made them no means of such protection; and (2) venerating people or things in a way that does not go so far as ascribing lordship to them, such as swearing by other than Allah, or saying “Were it not for Allah and so-and-so...”

Particularly in this era, one should be very careful regarding false creeds associated with shrines. It is prohibited to ask for anything, in any sense, from shrines — this is against the teachings of the Qur'an and the Sunnah of the Prophet (PBUH). Scholars of every sect have strictly refuted this practice. Muslims are only bound to follow the direct text of the Qur'an and Hadith, with no need to be involved in ambiguous and uncertain literature.

> *What I fear most about you is the minor shirk... Ar-riya (showing off). Allah will say on the Day of Judgment when He pays people for their deeds: Go to those for whom you performed riya in the world and see if you find any reward with them.*
>
> Hadith — Musnad Ahmad bin Hanbal: 57

> *...they feared men as they fear Allah, or with even greater fear.*
>
> Qur'an 4:77 (An-Nisa)

The Concept of Ownership

Regarding Tawhid, Muslims should understand clearly that everything we have belongs to Allah alone; we are merely caretakers or custodians of all valuables for a certain period. Ownership in reality belongs to Allah alone — that is why suicide has been declared forbidden, because even though this life is not truly ours, it belongs to Allah. We were created at the decided time and will die in the manner decided by Allah. Parents, children, money, every relation and possession we have belongs to Allah alone.

This is illustrated by the example of the Prophet's Companions — the most honoured and respected people in Islam. Following the conquest of Mecca, when the Muslims were at their greatest numerical strength, they fought the **Battle of Hunain** under the Prophet's direct leadership. Despite their large numbers, they faced severe hardship in this battle due to a single mistake: they began to attribute the success of their earlier victories to their own strength and effort rather than to the help and will of Allah. This momentary self-reliance led to a setback, teaching the lesson that victory does not come

from numbers, power, or human capability alone, but solely from Allah:

> *Indeed, Allah has given you believers' victory on many battlefields, even at the Battle of Hunain when you took pride in your great numbers, but they proved of no advantage to you. The earth, despite its vastness, seemed to close in on you, and then you turned back in retreat.*
>
> Qur'an 9:25 (At-Tawbah)

7. Belief in the Angels — Iman bil-Mala'ikah (pp. 40–41)

> *The Messenger has believed in what was revealed to him from his Lord, and so have the believers... They believe in Allah, His angels, His books, and His messengers...*
>
> Qur'an 2:285 (al-Baqarah)

> *The angels were created from light...*
>
> Hadith — Sahih Muslim: 2996

> *They do not disobey Allah in what He commands them but do what they are commanded.*
>
> Qur'an 66:6 (At-Tahrim)

> *They exalt Him night and day and do not slacken.*
>
> Qur'an 21:20 (Al-Anbiya)

The Four Archangels

- **Jibra'il (AS)** — the angel of revelation; delivered Allah's messages to the Prophets. (Qur'an 81:19–21)
- **Mikail (AS)** — responsible for sustenance and natural forces such as rain and vegetation.
- **Israfil (AS)** — will blow the Trumpet to signal the end of the world and the Day of Judgment.
- **Izrail (AS)** — the Angel of Death, tasked with removing the souls of the deceased.

8. Belief in the Books — Iman bil-Kutub (pp. 42–44)

- **The Tawrah** — revealed to Prophet Musa (AS) for the Children of Israel; contained commandments, legal rulings, spiritual teachings.
- **The Zabur (Psalms)** — revealed to Prophet Dawud (AS); focused on praise, worship and spiritual wisdom rather than law.
- **The Injeel (Gospel)** — revealed to Prophet 'Isa (AS); confirmed the Tawrah and emphasised mercy, compassion and love. The notes distinguish the original Injeel from the four later Gospels (Matthew, Mark, Luke, John), written by human authors.
- **The Qur'an** — the final, complete, and eternally preserved revelation to Prophet Muhammad (PBUH), confirming and correcting distortions in earlier scriptures.

> *Indeed, We sent down the Torah, in which was guidance and light. The prophets who submitted [to Allah] judged by it for the Jews...*
>
> Qur'an 5:44

> *And to David We gave the Zabur.*
>
> Qur'an 4:163 (An-Nisa)

> *And We sent, following in their footsteps, Jesus, the son of Mary, confirming that which came before him in the Torah; and We gave him the Gospel, in which was guidance and light.*
>
> Qur'an 5:46

> *He has revealed to you the Book in truth, confirming what was before it. And He revealed the Torah and the Gospel before as guidance for mankind, and He revealed the Criterion (the Qur'an).*
>
> Qur'an 3:3

> *Indeed, it is We who sent down the Reminder (the Qur'an), and indeed, We will be its Guardian.*
>
> Qur'an 15:9

Theological point: believing in all the divine books means acknowledging their divine origin and role in history — not following earlier scriptures as they exist today. The Qur'an is held to abrogate and supersede all previous revelations, remaining the final, fully preserved criterion.

9. Belief in the Prophets — Iman bir-Rusul (pp. 45–47)

Prophethood (*Nubuwwah*) is the divine system through which Allah guides humanity via chosen Prophets (Nabi) and Messengers (Rasul).

Mission of the Prophets

- Teach people about Allah's Oneness (Tawhid).
- Deliver divine laws (Shariah).
- Warn people against evil and disbelief.
- Give glad tidings of Paradise to believers and warn disbelievers of Hell.

> *[We sent] messengers as bringers of good tidings and warners so that mankind will have no argument against Allah after the messengers.*
>
> Qur'an 4:165

Infallibility (Ismah) of the Prophets

Prophets are divinely protected from major and minor sins, though they retain free will; any apparent “mistake” (e.g., Prophet Adam eating from the tree) is understood as human forgetfulness, not rebellion.

> *Indeed, in the Messenger of Allah you have an excellent example for whoever has hope in Allah and the Last Day and remembers Allah often.*
>
> Qur'an 33:21 (Al-Ahzab)

> *And We had already taken a promise from Adam before, but he forgot; and We found not in him determination [to disobey].*
>
> Qur'an 20:115 (Taha)

Miracles (Mu'jizat)

- **Prophet Ibrahim (AS):** the fire became cool and safe when he was thrown into it — “We said, O fire, be coolness and safety upon Abraham.” (Qur'an 21:69)
- **Prophet Musa (AS):** the sea split for him and his people — “Then We inspired to Moses, Strike the sea with your staff, and it parted, and each portion was like a great towering mountain.” (Qur'an 26:63)

Finality of Prophethood (Khatm an-Nubuwwah)

> *Muhammad is not the father of any man among you, but he is the Messenger of Allah and the Seal of the Prophets.*
>
> Qur'an 33:40 (Al-Ahzab)

Three supporting Hadiths cited:

- “There will arise thirty great liars in my Ummah, each of them claiming to be a Prophet. But I am the last of the Prophets, there is no Prophet after me.” — *Sunan Abu Dawood, Sahih: 4252*
- “The example of me and the Prophets before me is like a man who built a beautiful house... but one brick was missing. I am that last brick, and I am the last of the Prophets.” — *Sahih al-Bukhari: 3535*
- “You (Ali) are to me as Harun was to Musa, except that there is no Prophet after me.” — *Sahih Muslim: 2404*

10. Belief in the Day of Judgment — Iman bil-Yawm al-Akhira (pp. 48–50)

> *Indeed, the Hour is coming — there is no doubt about it — and Allah will resurrect those in the graves.*
>
> Qur'an 22:7 (Al-Hajj)

Barzakh — The Intermediate Phase

Death marks the soul's separation from the body; the soul then enters Barzakh, a realm between the physical world and the Day of Judgment, where it may experience comfort or punishment.

> *And behind them is a barrier (Barzakh) until the Day they are resurrected.*
>
> Qur'an 23:100 (Al-Mu'minun)

> *When a believer is buried, two angels come and ask... If he answers correctly, his grave is expanded and filled with light. If not, the grave is tight and filled with fire... He hears the beat of their sandals as they leave, and then he is questioned.*
>
> Hadith — Musnad Ahmad / Sahih al-Bukhari

Phases of the Day of Judgment (Yawm al-Qiyamah)

- **The Trumpet (Sur):** blown by the angel Israfil, causing all life to cease, then blown again after 40 years to resurrect the dead. “And the Trumpet will be blown, and all who are in the heavens and the earth will fall dead, except whom Allah wills.” (Qur'an 39:68, Az-Zumar)
- **The Great Intercession (Ash-Shafa'ah al-'Uzma):** after a long wait, people seek intercession from Prophet after Prophet until reaching Prophet Muhammad (PBUH), who will intercede to begin the Reckoning. (Jami' at-Tirmidhi)

Stages of the Reckoning (Hisab)

- **1) Distribution of the Book of Deeds** — the righteous receive it in their right hand; the wicked in their left hand or from behind their back. “Then as for he who is given his record in his right hand, he will be judged with an easy account... But as for he who is given his record behind his back, he will cry out for destruction.” (Qur'an 84:7–12, Al-Inshiqaq)
- **2) Weighing of Deeds (Mizan)** — “And We shall set up the scales of justice for the Day of Resurrection, so that no soul is treated unjustly in anything.” (Qur'an 21:47, Al-Anbiya)
- **3) Witnesses** — angels who recorded deeds, Prophets testifying for/against their nations, and even a person's own body parts. “That Day, their tongues, hands, and feet will testify against them about what they used to do.” (Qur'an 24:24, An-Nur)

Both Paradise (Jannah) and Hell (Jahannam) are real, eternal destinations. The full journey — Barzakh, Qiyamah, Reckoning, and final destination — underscores each person's accountability and the hope for Allah's mercy through sincere faith and righteous action.

11. Belief in Divine Decree — Iman bil-Qadar (pp. 51–52)

Belief in **Qadr** (divine destiny) and **Qadha** (divine execution/decree) — everything in the universe, good or bad, happens according to Allah's perfect knowledge and will.

Qadr — Divine Destiny

> *Indeed, We have created all things with Qadr (predestination).*
>
> Qur'an 54:49 (Al-Qamar)

> *Allah has set a measure for everything.*
>
> Qur'an 65:3 (At-Talaq)

Qadha — Divine Execution

Allah brings about events according to what He has already destined; human actions remain within our free will even though Allah's knowledge encompasses them.

> *Everyone will find easy that for which he was created.*
>
> Hadith — Sahih al-Bukhari

Dua and Destiny

Some aspects of destiny are fixed (definite) while others are conditional and can change through sincere prayer and repentance.

> *Nothing repels destiny except dua, and nothing increases lifespan except righteousness.*
>
> Hadith (cited in the notes)

12. Introduction to the Worship System — Ibadah (pp. 53–54)

Worship (*'ibadah*) in Islam is not confined to ritual performance; it extends to every aspect of life lived in accordance with divine guidance. Its purpose is to cultivate continuous God-consciousness (*taqwa*), spiritual discipline and communal unity.

The formal structure of worship is expressed through the **Five Pillars of Islam**:

- Shahadah — Declaration of Faith
- Salah — Prayer
- Zakah — Almsgiving
- Sawm — Fasting (during Ramadan)
- Hajj — Pilgrimage to Mecca

Beyond these obligatory acts, Islam also encourages voluntary worship (*nawafil*), ethical conduct, and social responsibility as integral expressions of faith.

The Shahadah (Declaration of Faith)

The Shahadah is the foundational pillar of Islam — the essential entry point into the faith, affirming the central tenet of Tawhid:

> *I bear witness that there is no Almighty God but Allah, and I bear witness that Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah.*

Theological Significance

- **Divine Unity (Tawhid):** recognising Allah as the sole Creator, Sustainer, and Ruler of the universe, with no partner in His divinity or attributes.
- **Prophethood (Risalah):** acknowledging Muhammad (PBUH) as the final messenger who conveyed Allah's final revelation (the Qur'an) to humanity.

The Shahadah functions as a personal covenant with Allah and a public affirmation of faith, implying acceptance of Allah's guidance, commitment to living by Islamic principles, and entrance into the global Muslim community (Ummah).

Ritual & Legal Role

- **Conversion to Islam:** sincerely uttering the Shahadah, with understanding and belief, is the sole requirement to become a Muslim.
- **Daily Worship:** the Shahadah is recited multiple times throughout the five daily prayers.
- **Social & Legal Recognition:** in Islamic jurisprudence (fiqh), a person's status as a Muslim is formally recognised through their articulation of the Shahadah.

Theological Foundations of Salah

> *Indeed, prayer has been decreed upon the believers a decree of specified times.*
>
> Qur'an 4:103

Prayer is viewed not merely as ritual, but as a spiritual ascent (*mi'raj*) for the believer, echoing the Prophet's own ascension (Isra wal Mi'raj), during which the command for Salah was revealed.

The Five Daily Prayers

Arabic Name	English Name	Time
Fajr	Dawn Prayer	Before sunrise
Zuhr	Noon Prayer	After the sun passes its zenith
'Asr	Afternoon Prayer	Late afternoon
Maghrib	Sunset Prayer	Immediately after sunset
'Isha	Night Prayer	After twilight disappears

Each prayer consists of a series of physical movements and recitations called *rak'at* (units): standing (*qiyam*), bowing (*ruku'*), and prostration (*sujud*), symbolising submission to Allah. Voluntary (*nafl*) and supererogatory (*sunnah*) prayers include **tahajjud** (late-night prayer) and **duha** (mid-morning prayer).

Conditions and Requirements

- **Purification (taharah):** ritual cleanliness through wudu (ablution) or ghusl (full-body purification) if required.
- **Proper attire:** covering the 'awrah (modesty requirements).
- **Clean space:** the place of prayer must be free from impurities.
- **Facing the Qiblah:** all prayers are directed toward the Ka'bah in Mecca.

Social and Spiritual Dimensions

Spiritually, Salah fosters remembrance of Allah (*dhikr*), inner peace, and a moral compass. Socially, it reinforces unity and equality, as all stand shoulder to shoulder regardless of status.

> *Indeed, prayer prohibits immorality and wrongdoing.*
>
> Qur'an 29:45

The Difference between Islam and Disbelief

> *The difference between worship and disbelief is the abandonment of prayer.*
>
> Hadith — Sunan Abu Dawood: 4678

Prayer is Obligatory in All Circumstances

Unlike Zakat and Hajj (waived for the poor) or fasting (leave granted to travellers and the sick), prayer remains obligatory upon every Muslim according to its fixed timings.

Last Advice of the Prophet (PBUH)

During his final illness, the Prophet repeatedly urged: “The prayer, and those whom your right hands possess” — until his tongue could no longer utter words.

The First Account on the Day of Judgment

The first deed a person will be called to account for is Salah. If it is sound, the rest of their deeds follow suit; if it is corrupted, they fail and lose.

Zakah (Almsgiving) — Third Pillar

Zakah is the compulsory act of almsgiving mandated as a means to purify wealth and assist those in need — both a form of worship and a social obligation designed to redistribute resources and promote economic justice.

> *And establish prayer and give Zakah and obey the Messenger, that you may receive mercy.*
>
> Qur'an 24:56

The term *Zakah* literally means “purification” and “growth”, reflecting the belief that giving Zakah purifies the giver's wealth and soul while fostering communal prosperity.

Purposes of Zakah

- Spiritual purification of the giver from greed and selfishness.
- Economic redistribution to reduce poverty and inequality.
- Social solidarity by strengthening bonds within the Muslim community.

Conditions and Eligibility

- **Nisab:** the minimum amount of wealth a Muslim must possess before Zakah becomes obligatory (threshold varies by asset type — gold, silver, cash, livestock, produce).
- **Hawl (one lunar year):** wealth must remain in possession continuously for one lunar year.
- **Type of wealth:** includes cash, savings, trade goods, agricultural produce, livestock, and certain investments.

Zakah is generally calculated at 2.5% (1/40) on monetary wealth, with different prescribed rates for agricultural produce and livestock.

Recipients of Zakah (Al-Asnaf)

> *Zakah expenditures are only for the poor and the needy, and those employed to collect [Zakah], and for bringing hearts together [for Islam], and for freeing captives [or slaves], and for those in debt, and for the cause of Allah, and for the [stranded] traveler.*
>
> Qur'an 9:60

- 1) The poor (fuqara)
- 2) The needy (masakin)
- 3) Those employed to collect Zakah ('amilin 'alayha)
- 4) Those whose hearts are to be reconciled (mu'allafatu qulubuhum)
- 5) Ransom of captives or slaves (firaq al-riqab)
- 6) Those in debt (gharimin)
- 7) In the cause of Allah (fi sabilillah)
- 8) The wayfarer (ibn al-sabil)

Different Islamic legal schools (*madhahib*) provide detailed rulings on types of wealth subject to Zakah, calculation methods, and exemptions/penalties for non-payment. Today Zakah remains a vital poverty-alleviation tool and continues to inspire modern Islamic finance and charitable organisations.

Sawm (Fasting) — Fourth Pillar

Fasting (Arabic *as-Sawm*, from a root meaning “to stop”) means to refrain from eating, drinking and sensual desires from dawn to sunset. It became obligatory on 10 Sha'ban, 2 AH, a year and a half after the Hijrah to Madinah.

> *O you who have believed, decreed upon you is fasting as it was decreed upon those before you, that you may become righteous.*
>
> Qur'an 2:183

Fasting is ordained during the month of **Ramadan**, the ninth month of the Islamic lunar calendar — the month in which the Qur'an was first revealed. The fast begins at *fajr* (dawn) and ends at *maghrib* (sunset), and is obligatory for every adult Muslim who is physically and mentally capable.

> *Fasting is prescribed for you as it was prescribed for the people before you, so that you may become pious.*

Leaving the Fast Without Excuse is a Grave Sin

> *Whoever breaks the fast during Ramadan without an allowance or illness, then if he fasted for all time, his fasting would not make up for it.*

The True Aim of Fasting

> *Whoever does not give up forged speech and evil actions, Allah is not in need of his leaving his food and drink (i.e. Allah will not accept his fasting).*
>
> Hadith — Sahih al-Bukhari

Benefits and Effects of Fasting

- It is a month of training to avoid evil and do good.
- Fasting makes a person accustomed to hardship.
- It creates a sense of empathy for others' suffering and problems.
- Fasting teaches punctuality.
- It builds spiritual strength, bringing one closer to Allah.
- It also helps to improve physical health.

Hajj (Pilgrimage) — Fifth Pillar

Hajj literally means “to intend to visit a place”. In Shari'ah, it refers to visiting the Ka'bah and performing the Hajj rituals on the specific days of Dhu al-Hijjah. It is the fifth and final pillar, becoming obligatory in 9 AH — a compulsory pilgrimage to Makkah for every Muslim who is physically and financially able, undertaken at least once in a lifetime.

> *And [due] to Allah from the people is a pilgrimage to the House — for whoever is able to find thereto a way.*
>
> Qur'an 3:97

Hajj traces its origins to Prophet Ibrahim (AS) and his family, regarded as founders of the sacred rituals associated with Makkah and the Ka'bah.

Timing

Hajj takes place annually during Dhu al-Hijjah, specifically from the 8th to the 12th (sometimes extending to the 13th). It coincides with the **Day of Arafah** (9th of Dhu al-Hijjah) — the climax of Hajj, considered the day of forgiveness and mercy.

Rituals of Hajj

- **Ihram:** entering a sacred state of ritual purity and intention — simple white garments for men, modest dress for women — while abstaining from cutting hair/nails and quarrelling.
- **Tawaf:** circumambulating the Ka'bah seven times counter-clockwise, demonstrating the unity of believers around Allah.
- **Sa'y:** walking seven times between the hills of Safa and Marwah, commemorating Hagar's search for water for her son Ishmael.
- **Standing at Arafah (Wuquf):** spending the afternoon on the plain of Arafah in prayer and reflection — considered the essential pillar of Hajj.
- **Muzdalifah:** collecting pebbles and spending the night under the open sky.
- **Ramy al-Jamarat:** throwing stones at three pillars representing the devil, symbolising rejection of temptation.
- **Eid al-Adha sacrifice:** commemorating Ibrahim's willingness to sacrifice his son, by slaughtering an animal (usually a sheep or goat).
- **Shaving or trimming hair:** signifying renewal and the conclusion of the state of ihram.
- **Final Tawaf al-Ifadah:** a further circumambulation of the Ka'bah, symbolising completion of the pilgrimage rites.

Spiritual and Social Dimensions

- **Equality and unity:** millions of Muslims, regardless of nationality or status, gather in identical simple attire to perform identical rituals.
- **Renewal of faith:** a reminder of submission to Allah and the transient nature of worldly life.
- **Collective identity:** fosters a strong sense of belonging to the global Muslim ummah.

Conditions and Eligibility

- **Islamic faith:** only Muslims may perform Hajj.
- **Maturity and sanity:** adults of sound mind.
- **Physical and financial ability:** one must be physically fit and financially capable without hardship to oneself or dependents.

If a Muslim cannot perform Hajj due to valid reasons such as illness or financial constraints, the obligation is waived or deferred.

Types of Pilgrimage

- **Hajj al-Tamattu':** the major/standard Hajj.
- **'Umrah:** a minor pilgrimage performable at any time of year, which does not fulfil the obligation of Hajj.
- **Hajj al-Qiran:** combining Hajj and 'Umrah in a single journey.

The rituals of Hajj have been preserved since the time of the Prophet (PBUH), with minor variations recognised among the Islamic legal schools. Over the centuries, Hajj has also served as a site of political, cultural and religious significance, shaping Islamic civilisation and identity.

This marks the end of the “Worship System of Islam” topic (the Five Pillars: Shahadah, Salah, Zakah, Sawm, Hajj). The course pack continues afterward into “Introduction to Islamic Jurisprudence (Usul al-Fiqh)” and further topics through page 126.

Compiled as a study aid from the uploaded course pack. Arabic script quotations were represented here by their English translations for readability; the original Arabic text and page-image formatting can be found in the source PDF.